Six card families. One rules language.

System overview

Design objective. A publisher-ready component system that separates acquisition, personal consequences, physical equipment, magical programming, independent companions, and private information.

White Mirror

Discovery generator

3 sockets · reveal all · Secret to discoverer

WM-##

Black Mirror

Hidden personal curse

Identical back · hidden personal curse

BM-##

Item

Equipment / Tool / Relic

Equipment / Tool / Relic · accessible in room

IT-##

Spell

Learning + Sigil casting

Element learning · strict colored Sigil sockets

SP-##

Companion

Creature behavior + relationship

Identity · behavior · movement · conflict

CO-##

Secret

Private discoverer reward

Private to discoverer · role still undecided

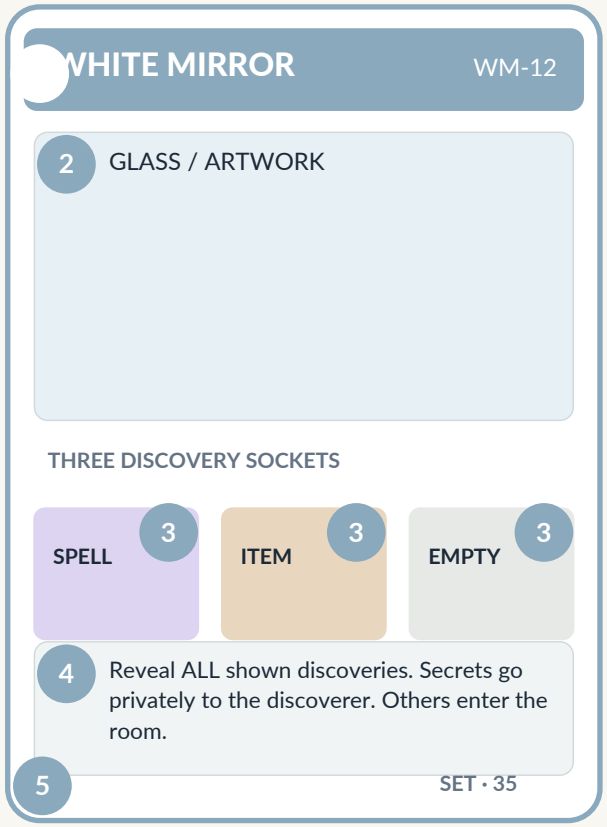
SE-##

Critical cross-card rules. Room objects are usable as if in the current hero's inventory. White Mirrors generate all printed discoveries immediately. Black Mirror curse targets only its flipper. Occuldor's arrival response is a different system. Strict Sigil matching and bound Sigil commitment are essential to Spell design.

WHITE MIRROR

Discovery generator

The only purpose of a White Mirror is to reveal its printed discovery symbols. No extra individual ability.



NUMBERED ANATOMY

01 Family label + ID
WHITE MIRROR and a stable WM-## identifier.

02 Artwork field
Bright silver / glass image, visually distinct from the black deck.

03 Three discovery sockets
Three equally sized icon slots: Spell, Item, Companion, Secret, or Empty.

04 Resolution reminder
Reveal every nonempty discovery: Secrets go privately to the discoverer; all others appear in the room.

05 Production marking
Card number and small expansion/version indicator, not gameplay text.

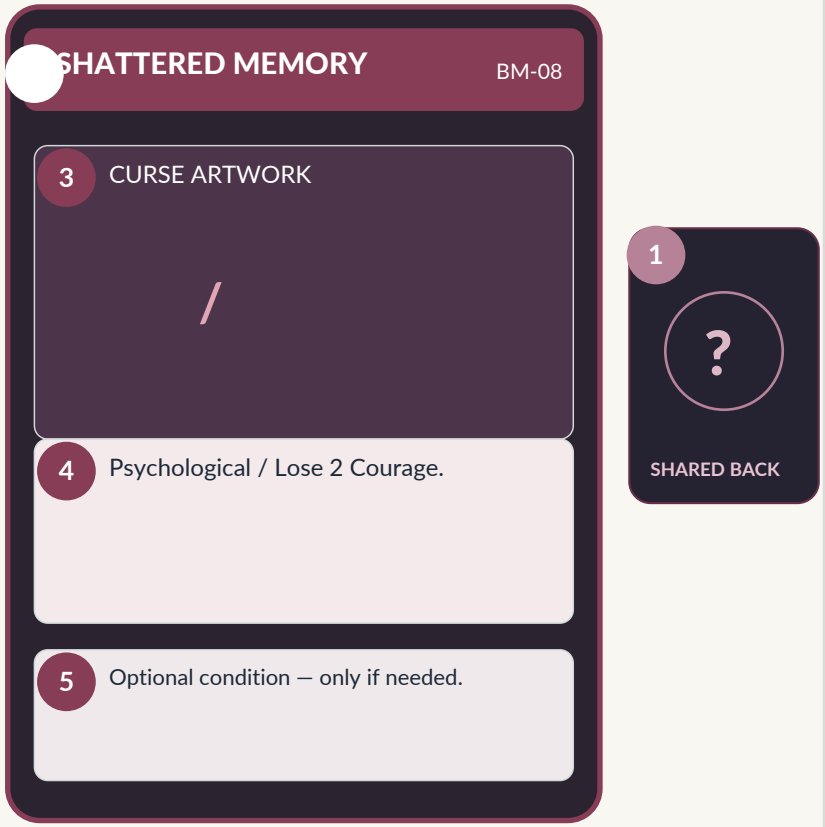
RULE / STATE NOTE

Confirmed: reveals all indicated discoveries immediately.
Proposed: place all three slots at the same visual weight; printed text only as a reminder.

BLACK MIRROR

Hidden personal curse

Players see only a shared Black Mirror back until flipped, unless a specific Spell or Item grants foresight.



NUMBERED ANATOMY

01 Shared identical back
No readable severity, family, title, or effect visible while face-down.

02 Curse title + ID
Unique evocative name; BM-## stays unobtrusive.

03 Curse family
Psychological / Material / Spatial / Supernatural / Castle-wide.

04 Primary curse
Concise imperative text, targeting the hero who flips the Black Mirror.

05 Optional condition
Only if genuinely required by this card; do not duplicate Occuldor arrival rules.

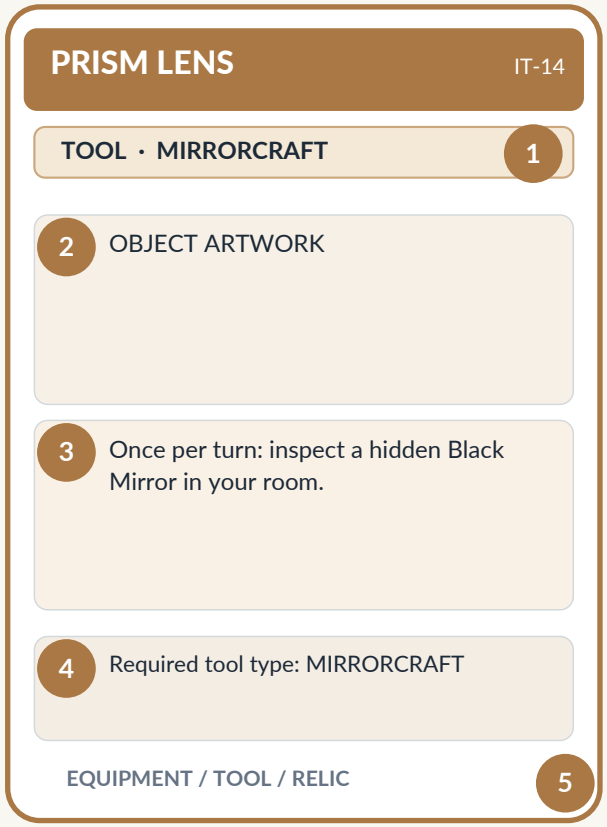
RULE / STATE NOTE

Confirmed: Black Mirror penalty is personal to its flipper. Occuldor arrival punishment is separate and affects heroes in his destination room.
Design rule: Castle-wide family may alter the environment, but must not secretly change the Black Mirror target rule.

ITEM

Equipment / Tool / Relic

One Item card frame with a highly visible subtype. An Item can be used when carried or while accessible in the current room.



NUMBERED ANATOMY

01 **Name + subtype**
EQUIPMENT, TOOL, or RELIC is immediately readable.

02 **Object illustration**
Recognizable silhouette; differentiate worn Relics from handheld Tools.

03 **Activation / effect**
Passive text, timing icon, or activation condition as appropriate.

04 **Tool requirement tag**
Tools print a clear subtype glyph used by Spell learning requirements.

05 **Slot and duration**
Equipment/Tool: one of 2 side slots; Relic: 1 dedicated character-board slot.

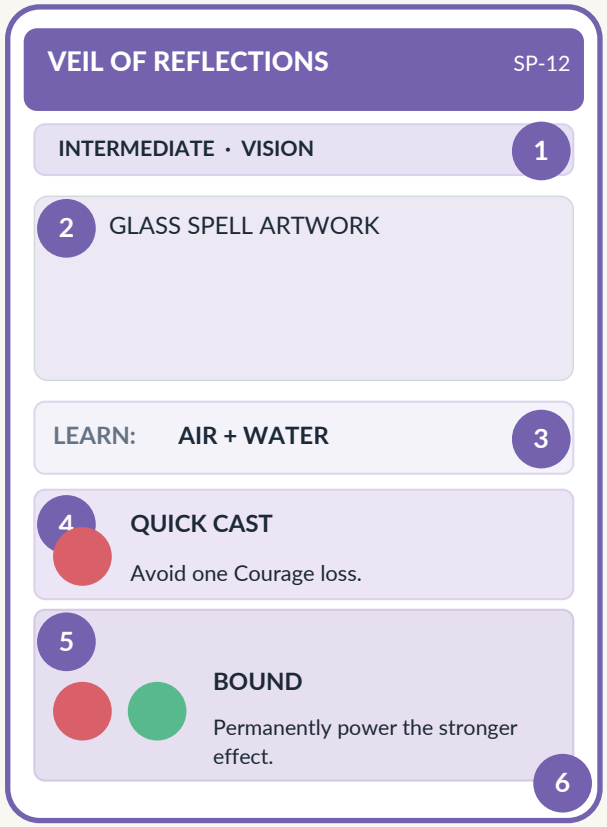
RULE / STATE NOTE

Confirmed start: 2 Equipment/Tool slots and 1 Relic slot, together forming 3 Item slots.
Room rule: anything in the current room can be used as if in inventory. Carry limits matter on departure.

SPELL

Learning + Sigil casting

A Spell card is a small programmable board: acquire knowledge, then occupy exactly matching colored/glyph Sigil sockets to activate modes.



NUMBERED ANATOMY

01 **Level + school + title**
Basic / Intermediate / Advanced; school tag optional.

02 **Learning cost**
Explicit Element glyphs, and Tool glyph when required.

03 **Mode A: Quick**
Exact-color socket(s), timing icon, effect, refresh rule (timing unresolved).

04 **Mode B: Bound**
Exact-color socket(s) with closed-lock convention; ongoing while assigned.

05 **Optional grouped mode**
Connect all required glyph sockets with a bracket to indicate simultaneous assignment.

06 **Unique rules box**
Any mutually exclusive configurations, constraints, or targets.

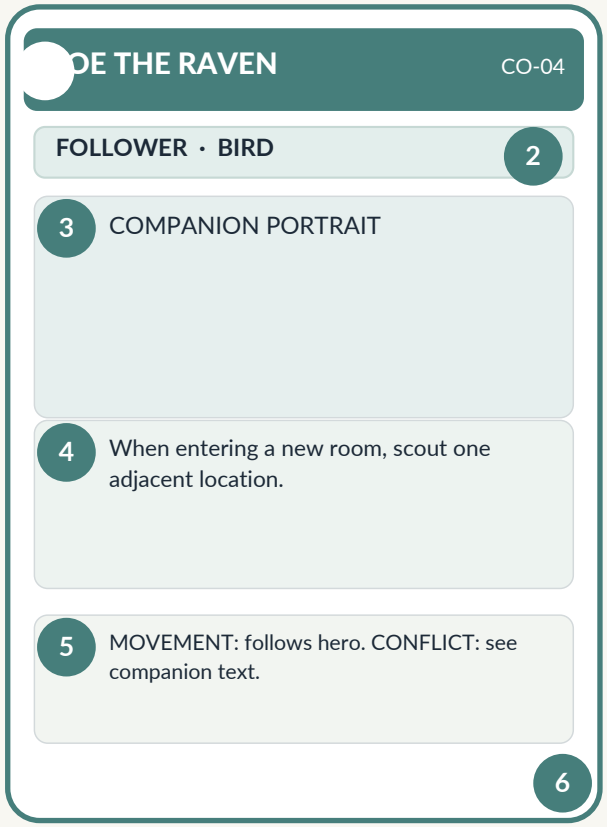
RULE / STATE NOTE

Confirmed: printed activation sockets exceed 35 physical Sigils; strict glyph/color matching; bound Sigils cannot be freely moved while powering a Spell.
Knowledge: four unlockable Spell slots from Sigil collection milestones.

COMPANION

Creature behavior + relationship

Companions are characters in the castle, not passive inventory bonuses. Their movement and conflict rules must be legible.



NUMBERED ANATOMY

01 Name + identity
Companion name, species / supernatural type, CO-##.

02 Behavior badge
Follower / Resident / Wanderer are proposed labels pending approval.

03 Portrait
Creature silhouette large enough for figurine identification.

04 Ability text
Clear frequency and who benefits when visiting the room or traveling with it.

05 Movement / conflict
Stays, follows, transfers, flees, or cannot coexist: include only relevant line.

06 Carry requirement
If the creature must be carried, specify what slot or capacity it occupies.

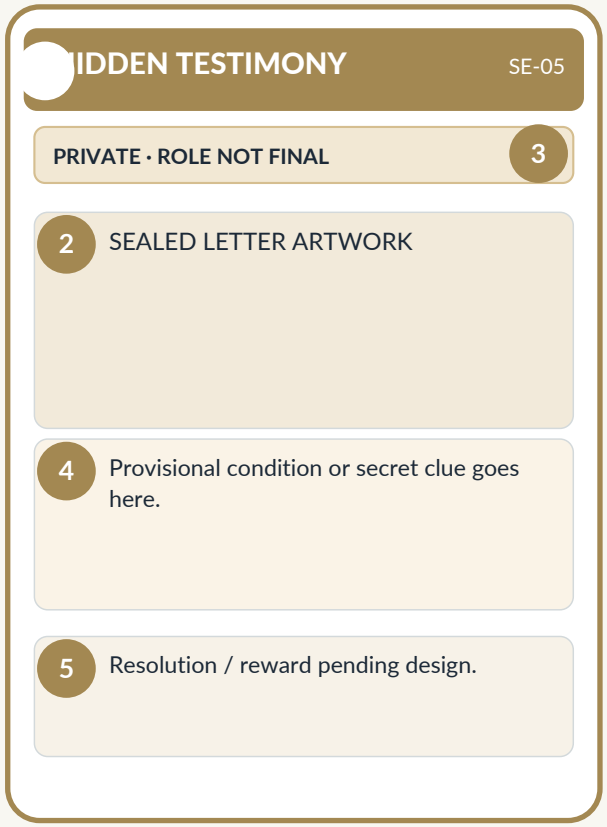
RULE / STATE NOTE

Confirmed discovery count: 10. A Companion revealed by White Mirror appears in the room. Exact joining/ownership rules remain open.

SECRET

Private discoverer reward

Secrets bypass the shared-room discovery pool. A player receives Secret cards privately when discovering a White Mirror.



NUMBERED ANATOMY

01 **Back / privacy identity**
All Secret card backs must be identical and give no clue about type.

02 **Secret title + ID**
Visible only to the owning player.

03 **Provisional role**
Objective / Knowledge / Trigger are possible design tags, NOT confirmed card subtypes.

04 **Private condition**
If needed, specify exactly when and how this card may be used.

05 **Reward / resolution**
How effect resolves or is claimed (to be established during Secret design).

RULE / STATE NOTE

Confirmed: cards belong only to the White Mirror discoverer, stay secret, and do not use capacity. Mechanical types and resolution are still open.

Production specification

Physical + information system

COMPONENT DIMENSIONS

TRIM SIZE	63 × 88 mm (standard poker-sized working format)
BLEED	3 mm on all sides (69 × 94 mm export canvas)
SAFE ZONE	4 mm inward from the trim edge; 5 mm preferred for text
RESOLUTION	300 dpi minimum for raster illustration at print size
PRINT MODE	CMYK / embedded color profile as required by manufacturer
STOCK / FINISH	Prototype: matte; production finish to be specified
CORNER RADIUS	Approximately 3 mm; confirm vendor die-line
MINIMUM RULES TEXT	8.5 pt goal at actual card size; never rely on microtext

COMPONENT STATES

White Mirror	Face-up discovery generator; no individual ability.
Black Mirror	Common opaque back; face revealed on flip or specific foresight.
Item	Subtype icon must correspond to player-board slot type.
Spell	Separate LEARN from CAST; printed sockets large enough for tokens.
Companion	Card and figurine must share unmistakable ID / silhouette.
Secret	Uniform back. Never display private text publicly.

Accessibility: color + distinct glyph on all five Sigil families; use icons and text for category; provide contrast-tested text panels; never identify cards by border color alone.

Decision register + release checklist

Do not hard-code unresolved mechanics

The specification distinguishes confirmed system rules from art-direction recommendations and rules pending playtest. These items are deliberately left unresolved so future card designs do not silently change game rules.

White Mirror distribution

35 cards / 3 discovery sockets; exact weighted 35-pattern list pending final validation.

Spell timing

Refresh cadence for Quick Sigils, restrictions on mode coexistence, and loss/recovery of bound Sigils remain open.

Sigil color supply

Seven of each color versus unequal rarity: not yet ratified; same bright vitrage palette + unique glyphs.

Character slots

4 learned Spell slots unlocked by collecting: 1 Sigil / 3 distinct / 3 same / all 5 distinct. Precise milestone tests need playtest.

Kaleidoscope bonus

+1 Courage for placement; +1 touching same-colored piece; +2 touching different-colored piece. If multiple neighbors, stacking method still open.

Item subtypes

Exactly how many Equipment, Tools, and Relics make up 25 Items is open.

Spell learning

Suggested 35 spells split 16 / 11 / 8 (Basic/Intermediate/Advanced); element costs and consumption not final.

Companions + Secrets

Follower / Resident / Wanderer and Objective / Knowledge / Trigger are proposed classifications only.

Approval gate: before illustrating the 35 Spells or printing card prototypes, freeze the five Sigil glyphs, socket size, discovery distribution, Item subtype counts, and a common timing vocabulary.